Customer Journey Map

Phase 2: Requirement Analysis

1. Journey Overview

The journey starts when a traveller opens trvale-book in the browser and ends when the traveller has reviewed, adjusted, saved or printed an itinerary. The design is built around one main task: turn trip preferences into an organized, budget-aware plan.

2. Stage One: Discover and Understand

The landing page explains the product with a hero section, an interactive sample preview and three steps: share your travel style, let the AI synthesize an itinerary, then tweak, recalculate and export. The traveller can sign in, sign up, or use the one-click demo sign-in to explore immediately.

3. Stage Two: Enter Preferences

The Trip Architect wizard has five steps: Destination and Dates; Travelers and Budget (traveller type, count, budget and currency in USD, EUR, GBP or JPY, with an approximate per-day amount); Style and Interests (budget, balanced or luxury; relaxed, moderate or packed; nine interest tags); Dietary and Requirements; and Final Review. Each step is validated before the user can continue, for example a blank destination, an end date earlier than the start date, a budget below 100, or no interest selected.

4. Stage Three: Generate the Itinerary

On the final step the frontend calls the backend generate endpoint. The backend validates the request, builds a prompt, calls the configured AI provider, hydrates the response with identifiers, and computes a budget breakdown. If no provider is configured, or the call fails, a built-in heuristic generator produces the plan so the flow still completes. If the backend is unreachable, the frontend falls back to a client-side generator. A loading indicator is shown during this stage.

5. Stage Four: Review and Refine

The itinerary page shows the title, destination, dates, a budget summary and day tabs. Each activity shows its time slot, start time, duration, estimated cost, location and a booking tip. On the edit page the user can change or delete activities, and a day can be regenerated; the budget is recalculated after changes.

6. Stage Five: Save and Return

Trips appear on the dashboard and on the Saved Trips page, where they can be searched by title or destination and filtered by travel style. A trip can be opened, edited or deleted after a confirmation dialog.

7. Stage Six: Export

The Print / PDF button calls the browser print dialog. A print stylesheet hides the navigation, sidebar, tabs and action buttons so that all days print as a clean document, and the user can choose Save as PDF.

8. Journey Improvement Priorities

- Give clear feedback during generation and make failures recoverable.
- Make clear that costs are estimates and that the heuristic fallback is not a live AI result.
- Test the saved-trips flow after a reload and across sign-in sessions.
- Check layouts on small screens and with keyboard navigation.
- Add a visible indicator when a plan was produced by the fallback generator.

This map is derived from the implemented flow and the intended experience. It is not a measured usability study; user testing is needed before claims about satisfaction or completion rates are made.